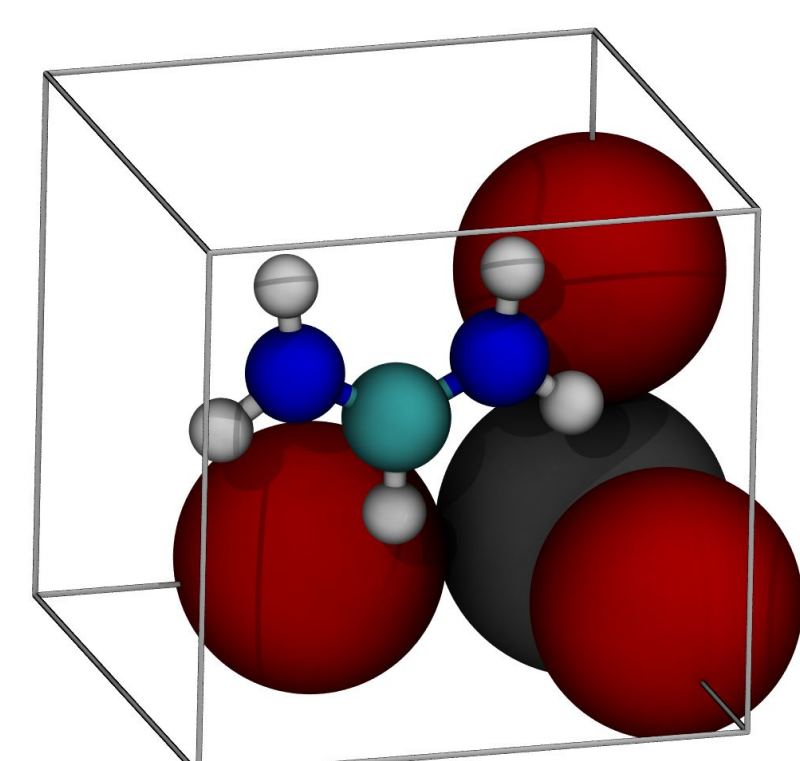


Investigating the Defect Behavior and Electronic Properties of Formamidinium Lead Bromide Perovskite through Machine Learned Interatomic Potentials

Rachel Lee, John Michael Lane, Woodrow Neal Wilson, Neeraj Rai

Introduction

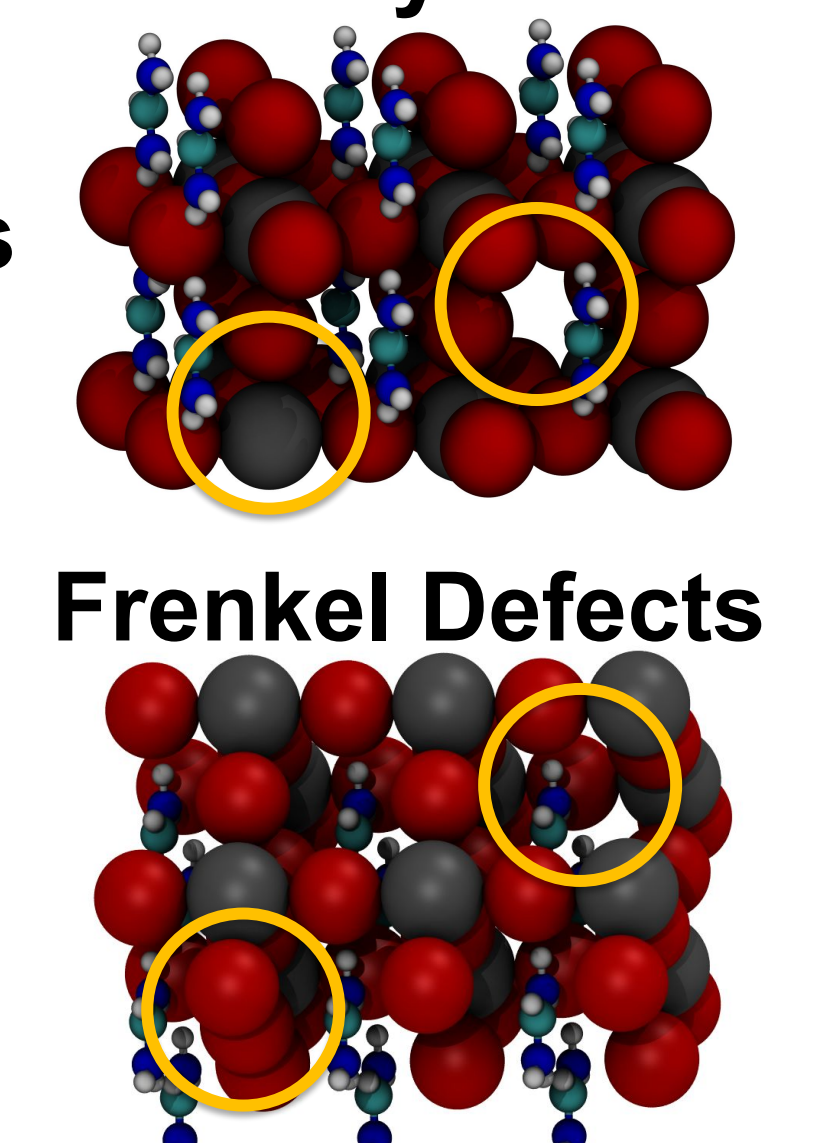
- FAPbBr₃ is a promising material for many optoelectronic devices, including light emitting diodes, photoelectrodes, and solar fuel cells
- Electronic properties affected by presence of defects in the crystal



Vacancy Defects

Interstitial Defects

Schottky Defects

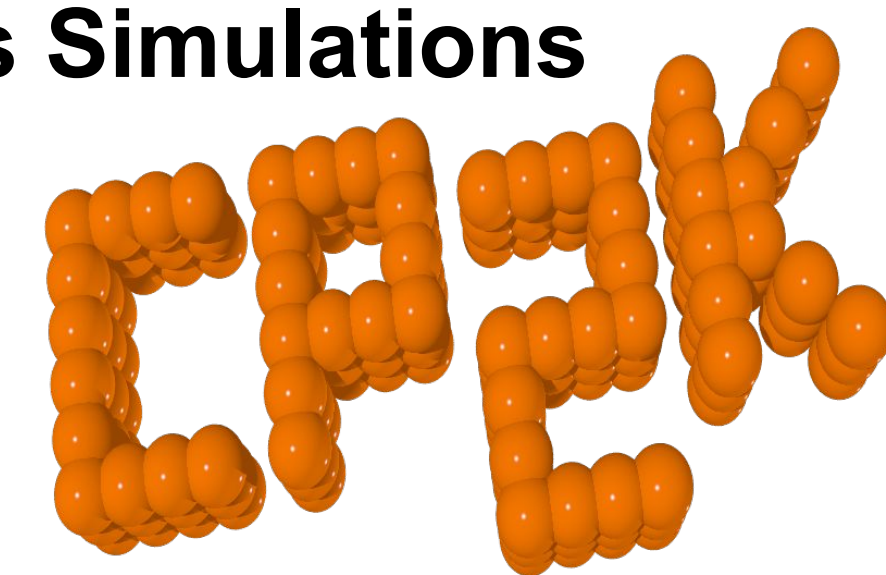


Frenkel Defects

Computational Details

Ab initio Molecular Dynamics Simulations

- Basis set: DZVP-MOLOPT-SR-GTH
- Pseudopotential: GTH-PBE
- XC Functionals: GGA-X-PBE, GGA-C-PBE
- Timestep: 0.5 fs
- Ensemble: Canonical (NVT)



Perfect Systems	Systems with Vacancy Defects	Systems with Interstitial Defects	Systems with Schottky Defects	Systems with Frenkel Defects
Unit cell • 298K • 600K	Unit cell • 298K • 600K	Unit cell • 298K • 600K	2x2x3 • 298 K • 600 K	2x2x3 • 298 K • 600 K
4x4x1 • 298K • 600K	4x4x1 • 298K • 600K	4x4x1 • 298K • 600K		
4x4x2 • 298K • 600K	4x4x2 • 298K • 600K	4x4x2 • 298K • 600K		

Electronic Structure Calculations

- DFT Functionals: DFT-D3 for geometry optimization, HSE06 for band structure calculations
- Gaussian Smearing: $\sigma = 0.05$
- Cutoff Energy: 500 eV
- Energy Difference: 1×10^{-6} eV
- Kpoint Grid: $4 \times 4 \times 4$ Monkhorst-Pack

Training Machine Learning Models

- Number of Features: 64
- Maximum Body Order: 3
- Angular Momentum (l): 1
- Cutoff Radius: 5 Å
- Number of Layers: 2

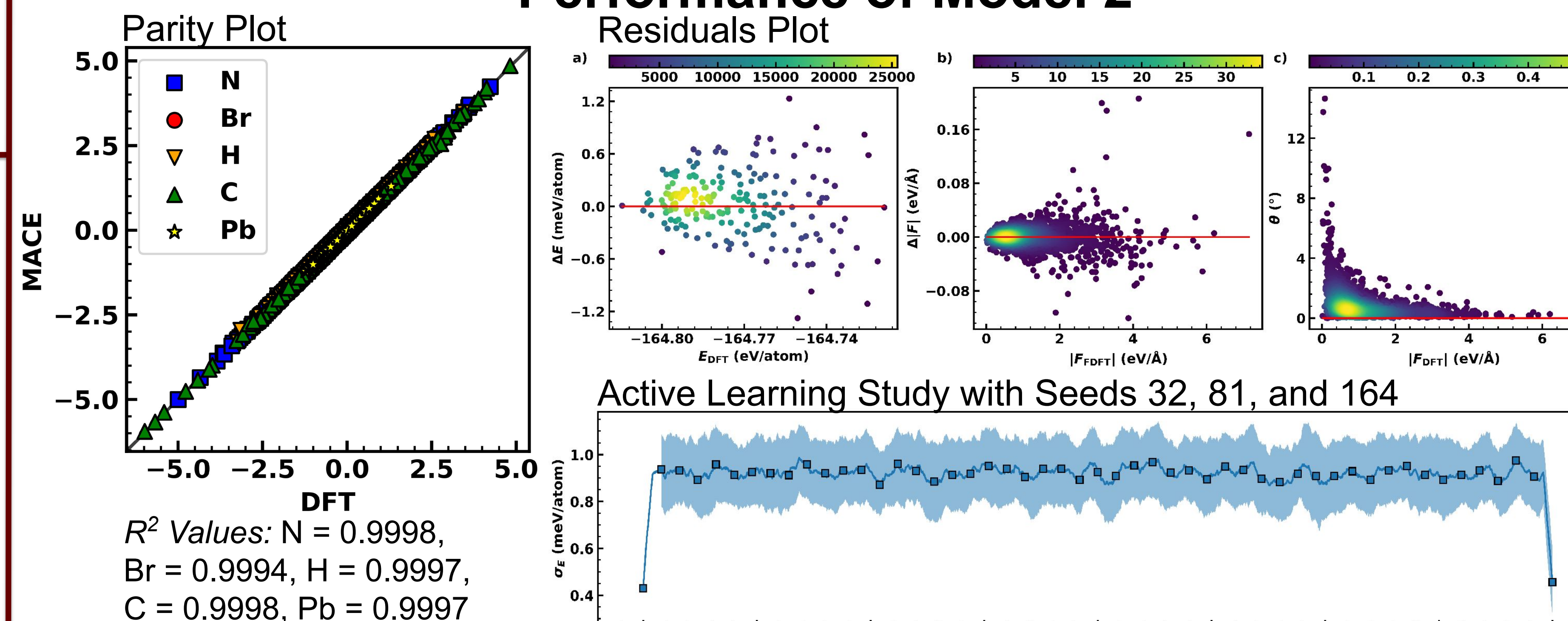


Results & Discussion

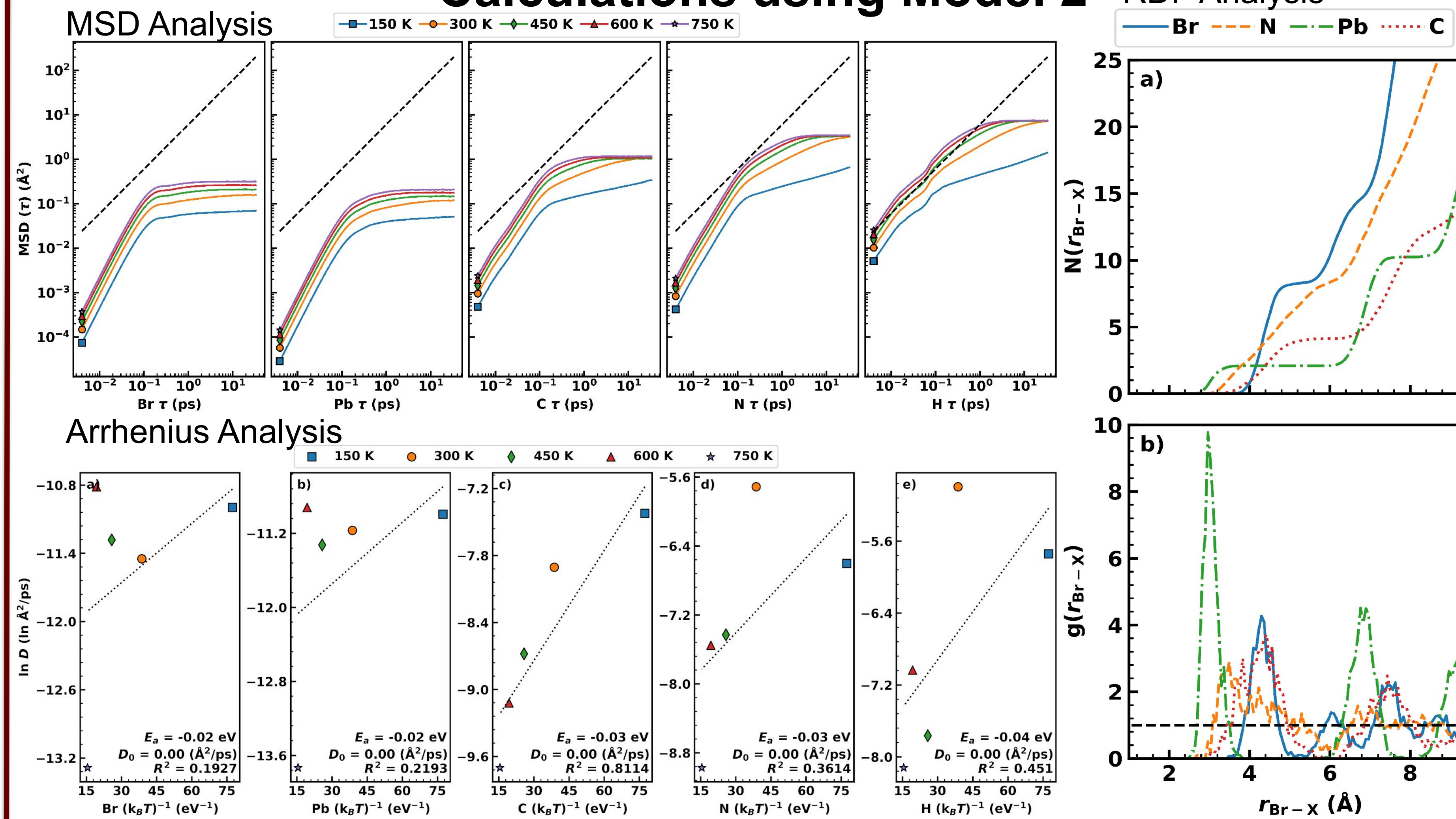
Models Trained

	No Defects (Perfect)			Defects (Frenkel and Schottky)		
	Model 2			Model 3		
	Model 4			Model 5		
Model	RMSE E (meV/atom)	RMSE F (meV/Å)	Relative F RMSE (%)	RMSE E (meV/atom)	RMSE F (meV/Å)	Relative F RMSE (%)
Model 0	9.3	103.3	14.53	5.3	119.7	16.55
Model 1	8.0	90.9	12.62	4.2	82.6	11.48
Model 2	0.3	8.6	1.04	0.3	12.5	1.43
Model 3	4.9	72.0	9.79	6.0	70.3	9.46
Model 4	2.2	93.2	11.98	2.5	108.0	13.23
Model 5	4.9	117.5	15.54	3.6	127.5	16.30

Performance of Model 2

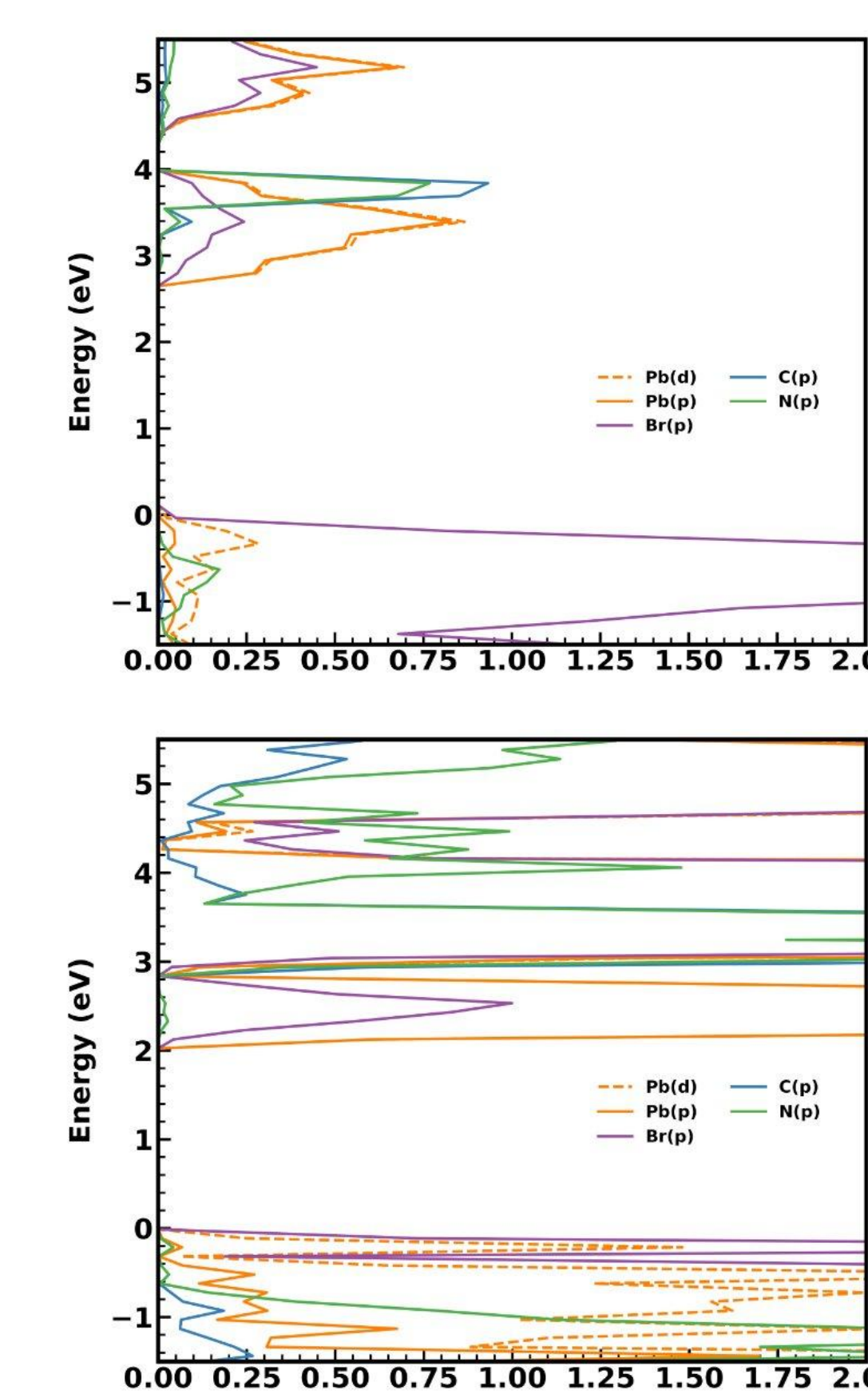
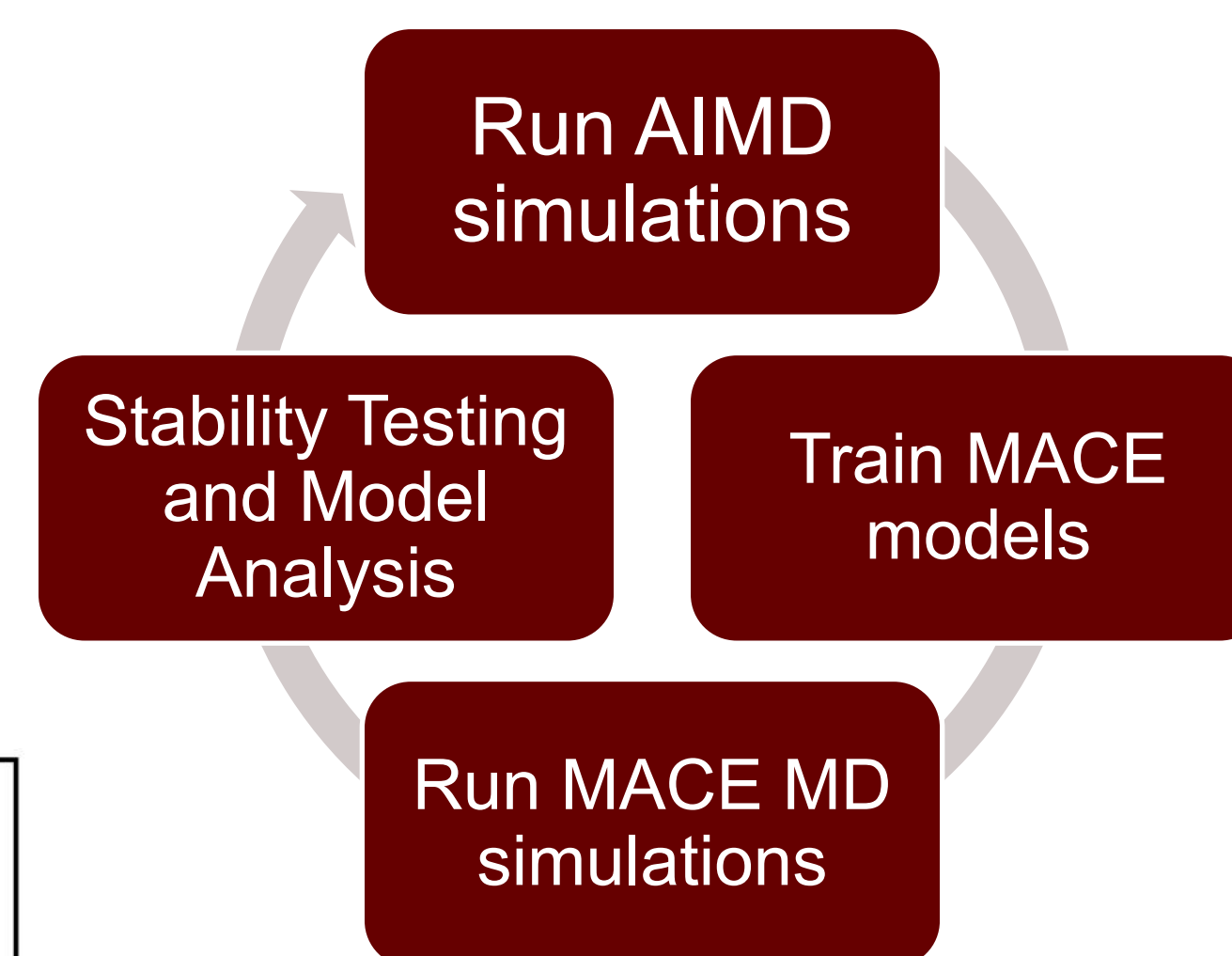


Calculations using Model 2

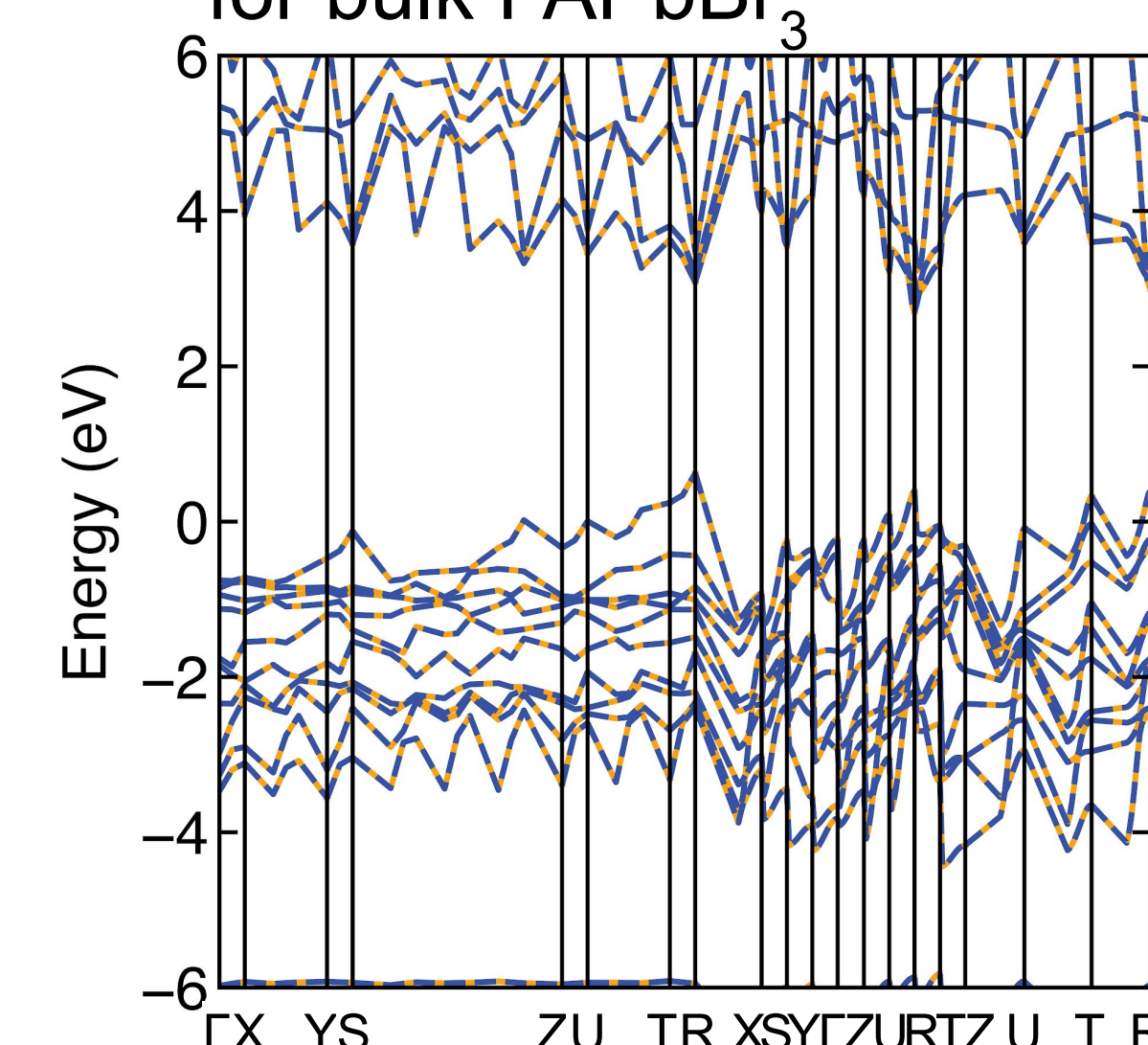


Future Work

- Continue training models to reduce model error
- Band structure and density of states calculations



Band structure calculation for bulk FAPbBr₃



References

- (1) Pols, M.; Brouwers, V.; Calero, S.; Tao, S. How Fast Do Defects Migrate in Halide Perovskites: Insights from on-the-Fly Machine-Learned Force Fields. *Chem. Commun.* **2023**, 59 (31), 4660–4663. <https://doi.org/10.1039/D3CC00953J>.
- (2) Chen, D.; Sergeev, A. A.; Zhang, N.; Ke, L.; Wu, Y.; Tang, B.; Tao, C. K.; Liu, H.; Zou, G.; Zhu, Z.; An, Y.; Li, Y.; Portniagin, A.; Sergeeva, K. A.; Wong, K. S.; Yip, H.-L.; Rogach, A. L. Ultralow Trap Density FAPbBr₃ Perovskite Films for Efficient Light-Emitting Diodes and Amplified Spontaneous Emission. *Nat Commun* **2025**, 16 (1), 2367. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-56557-8>.
- (3) Batatia, I.; Kovacs, D. P.; Simm, G.; Ortner, C.; Csanyi, G. MACE: Higher Order Equivariant Message Passing Neural Networks for Fast and Accurate Force Fields. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* **2022**, 35, 11423–11436.
- (4) Drautz, R. Atomic Cluster Expansion for Accurate and Transferable Interatomic Potentials. *Phys. Rev. B* **2019**, 99 (1), 014104. <https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.99.014104>.
- (5) Dussan, G.; Bachmayr, M.; Csányi, G.; Drautz, R.; Etter, S.; van der Oord, C.; Ortner, C. Atomic Cluster Expansion: Completeness, Efficiency and Stability. *Journal of Computational Physics* **2022**, 454, 110946. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcp.2022.110946>.

Acknowledgments

This work was supported in part by funding from the National Science Foundation through Grant No. DMR-2348712. Any findings, opinions, conclusions, or recommendations expressed in this material are those of the authors and do not necessarily reflect views of the National Science Foundation.